suspicion and fear that the Bangladesh policy-makers feel about the motives of India. A scientific and systematic strategy should be evolved to overcome this suspicion. Moreover, it has to be kept in mind that the Indian diplomacy in

Dhaka has to function in a highly politicised atmosphere. Therefore, it is not a job which the ordinary run of diplomats can do effectively. Either diplomats with intense political awareness or politicians with necessary diplomatic skill can do justice to the challenging task.

There were also suggestions from the spy agency to increase people-to-people contact and invite influential leaders from the political, religious and educational spheres of Bangladeshi small towns to India to witness a secular society where Muslims enjoy religious freedom, so that, upon their return, they might be able to counter false anti-India propaganda. The espionage community felt that there were already sufficient grounds for a 'cultural conquest' of Bangladesh using media such as cinema, theatre, music and journals.

To avoid possible harm to the Hindu minorities of Bangladesh, the R&AW suggested that the Indira government warn the Bangladesh regime that any large exodus of Hindu minorities into India would be considered an unfriendly and hostile act. The agency believed that such a warning would have sufficient impact on any government in Dhaka, thanks to the indelible memory of India's active military action in 1971 that helped create Bangladesh.

The Heartbroken Spies

From the serpentine alleys of downtown Calcutta (now Kolkata), Baldev Krishna had watched the birth of Bangladesh.